Program development plan template

This template is designed to guide schools through the process of planning, implementing, analysing and reflecting on the development of their IB programs. Use of IB templates is not required, but it is encouraged. Schools may use or modify this template or the template included in the self-study questionnaire available on the Program Resource Centre. Schools may also develop their own templates. However, the aspects of the process detailed below need to be included in the school's plan.

Refer to *Program development in IB World Schools* for guidance and a list of resources. As you engage in program development planning, be aware that the primary audience for this plan is the school community, not the IB. If you select this plan to submit for program evaluation, it can be edited to help the evaluation team and the IB World School (IBWS) manager understand what the school did and why. However, as you engage in the process, experiment to find a format that works for the school and helps to accomplish the goals the school has set for itself.

Name of school	IB school code
New Renaissance Middle School	060099
IB program(s) ☐ **PYP** ☒ **MYP** ☐ **DP** ☐ **CP**	

Start date of plan	Completion date of plan
August 11, 2025	June 4, 2026
[This space is for additional information or details the school wants to record about this plan.]	

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Planning

Complete this planning section at the start of the program development planning process

Focus of program development: **Consider what question(s) the school wants to answer, or what challenge(s) the school is facing, or what goal(s) the school wants to achieve. Identify one focus from your considerations and state it here. The school can start by identifying a general goal or area of focus. This will lead to the school developing a specific goal with a defined impact on student learning.**

Establish a focus that will have a positive impact on the student learning experience.

- *If all requirements for the program(s) are in place, identify a focus based on information or data that will enhance development of the program(s).*
- *If some requirements are not in place, consider what the root causes of the gap might be and how to use the program development planning process to strengthen program fundamentals.*
- *Set an appropriately challenging goal that will motivate the school community.*
- *Align program development goals with school strategic goals.*

The primary focus of our IB Program Development Plan for this school year is to build teacher capacity in unit planning and strengthen horizontal and interdisciplinary collaboration across all subject areas. We are currently navigating changes to instructional staff and welcoming many new educators unfamiliar with the MYP framework. This focus is designed to ensure that all teachers, regardless of IB experience level, are equipped to design rigorous, concept-based units that align with the standards and practices of the MYP. Our focus will be on collaborative horizontal planning processes, so that teachers within the same year level are designing units that reinforce shared ATL skills, global contexts, and eventually, opportunities for interdisciplinary learning. Strengthening these practices will help us promote consistency in instructional delivery, deepen student engagement, and foster authentic connections within the subject areas. This focus aligns with our school's broader goals of improving academic outcomes and building stronger connections across the learning community.

Rationale: **Briefly summarize the reasons the school selected this focus for program development. Describe the current situation (for example, evidence from student data, alignment with the school strategy, feedback in the verification visit report or the evaluation report). Explain why focusing on this area for program development is important to your school community.**

- *Identify a clear rationale based on, for example, student data, the school strategy, the verification visit report or the evaluation report.*

This focus was chosen in response to our current school realities and long-term goals. Changes to instructional staff has resulted in many new staff members who need support in learning the program and developing MYP-aligned units that integrate inquiry, concept-based instruction, and ATL skills. Our student achievement is trending upward, reflected in our school grade improving from a "C" to a "B." To keep this momentum, we must ensure consistent, high-quality instruction built on a shared understanding of the MYP. To sustain this progress, continued focus on teacher development and curriculum alignment will be essential. This focus also aligns with our strategic goals of improving student success and strengthening community connection. By prioritizing planning and collaboration, we aim to equip teachers to create learning experiences that are authentic, relevant, and connected to the world beyond the classroom. In turn, this will deepen student engagement, enrich our school culture, and support the long-term sustainability of the program.

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Planning		
	Guiding questions and prompts	**School response**
IB practices	**Identify one or two practices to answer each question. Select practices from at least two categories of the *Program standards and practices* (PSP) framework.** *To understand the structure of the PSP and learn how to identify practices, see the Guide to program evaluation, "Appendix 4: Using the PSP for the self-assessment".* *The motif builder app can help with selecting practices.* *Check that you have selected a total of 4–8 practices from at least two different categories of the PSP framework.*	Our work will be guided by both learning and cultural practices within the PSP framework. To strengthen learning practices, all teachers, especially those new to the IB, will use the IB planner to design concept-driven units that meet MYP requirements. This will be supported through guided planning sessions with the IB Coordinator, structured review protocols, and the intentional inclusion of ATL skills and global contexts. The IB Coordinator will push-in to classrooms during both instructional and non-instructional time to support teachers in their implementation of the MYP unit plans. Additionally, both IB Coordinator and teachers will be responsible for creating a print-rich environment that supports the MYP framework. We will also emphasize engaging students as inquirers and thinkers by providing structured collaborative planning sessions that help teachers integrate inquiry into unit design and create GRASPS-based summative assessments. Finally, cross-curricular and horizontal planning will be used to map ATL skills consistently across subjects, helping students transfer their learning more effectively. On the cultural side, we will establish the conditions that allow this work to take place. Our school will continue to provide designated time and resources for collaboration by embedding common planning into the professional development schedule and hosting bi-weekly professional development with IB-trained lead teachers and IB Coordinator. We will also introduce peer-review protocols for unit plans and assessments and build teacher-led learning communities that strengthen interdisciplinary connections and the sharing of best practices. Finally, we will expand professional learning by offering onboarding sessions and ongoing workshops that help new staff build a strong understanding of MYP principles, international-mindedness, and strategies for embedding the learner profile in unit planning.
	• What practice or practices indicate **why** the school is undertaking the work? That is, what is the reason for this focus?	The reason for this focus is grounded in the need to build teacher capacity and ensure consistency in program delivery. Changes to instructional staff has made it essential to prioritize protected time and resources for collaboration so that both new and returning staff can plan effectively within the MYP framework. There is also a clear need to provide ongoing professional development in international-mindedness and the IB philosophy to help teachers unfamiliar with the program grow in their practice. Finally, consistent use of the IB planner in unit design must be strengthened across subject areas, as this will safeguard instructional quality and sustain the academic gains our school has recently achieved.
	• What practice or practices need to be in place for this development to be successful? That is, what practices identify the **conditions** that are needed for success?	For this development to be successful, several key practices must be firmly in place to create the right conditions for growth. Teachers need to consistently use the IB planner as the foundation for unit development and review, ensuring that units are concept-driven, inquiry-based, and aligned with MYP expectations. This requires protected common planning time and access to resources that allow teachers to collaborate meaningfully. Structured processes, such as peer-review protocols, bi-weekly workshops, and interdisciplinary planning meetings, also need to be established to make collaboration purposeful and reflective. Finally, ongoing professional learning and onboarding for new staff must be provided so that all teachers develop a shared

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		understanding of the IB philosophy, international-mindedness, and the role of ATL skills and the learner profile in unit planning. Together, these practices create the foundation that allows teacher development to take root and ensures a consistent, high-quality learning experience for students.
	• What practice or practices identify the people **who** are responsible for the work? For example, teachers, leadership, students?	Responsibility for this work is shared across the school community. School leaders and the IB Coordinator are responsible for establishing the structures that make collaboration possible, such as protected common planning time, interdisciplinary meetings, and bi-weekly workshops. The IB coordinator also take the lead in onboarding new staff, providing ongoing professional development, and monitoring the quality of unit planning to maintain alignment with MYP expectations. Teachers are responsible for engaging in these structures by using the IB planner to design concept-driven units, collaborating with colleagues, and applying feedback to improve practice. Students contribute by actively participating in inquiry-based learning experiences and reflecting on their growth, but it is the leadership's role to create the conditions that allow both teachers and students to thrive.
	• What practice or practices show **how** the work will be done? That is, what actions will be taken?	The work will be carried out through intentional structures and sustained professional learning that guide teachers in unit planning and collaboration. Leadership will provide protected planning time, and ensure teacher compliance. The IB Coordinator will establish peer-review protocols, and host bi-weekly workshops to ensure teachers have the resources and support they need. Teachers will use the IB planner as the foundation for unit development and review, embedding ATL skills, global contexts, and inquiry-based assessments such as GRASPS tasks. Cross-curricular and horizontal planning meetings will be used to align skills and concepts across subjects, making learning experiences more coherent for students. Together, these actions create a cycle of planning, feedback, and reflection that strengthens teacher capacity and improves the quality of student learning across the program.
Impact (state the goal)	**What will change for students?** *Develop a specific goal that will help to improve the student learning experience.* *Consider adding specific, well-defined impact statements that will result from achieving the goal.* *Consider from the start how to determine and then demonstrate the impact on the student experience.* *Identify the target: all students or subsets of students.*	By strengthening unit planning and interdisciplinary collaboration, students will experience more consistent, engaging, and inquiry-driven learning across all subject areas. As teachers refine their use of the IB planner and embed ATL skills more intentionally, students will benefit from clearer connections between subjects, authentic learning opportunities, and assessments that emphasize critical thinking, problem-solving, and application of knowledge. The increased use of inquiry and the GRASPS model will further ensure that students develop as independent thinkers who can transfer their skills to real-world contexts. Our goal is to ensure that all MYP students have access to cohesive, concept-driven units that integrate ATL skills across disciplines and engage them through inquiry-based learning and authentic assessment. The impact of this work will be evident as students more frequently transfer ATL skills between subjects, participate in interdisciplinary tasks that highlight meaningful connections, and show growth in inquiry and critical thinking through their summative assessments. In addition, students will experience greater consistency in instructional expectations, helping to reduce learning gaps caused by teacher turnover. To determine and demonstrate impact, we will gather multiple sources of evidence, including student performance on summative assessments, reflections from interdisciplinary projects, ATL skills tracking across subjects, and student feedback collected through reflections, advisory sessions, or surveys.

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Data and evidence	**How will you learn what the impact on students is?** *What information, data or evidence will be gathered? Identify appropriate data sources early in the process that will show the impact on students.* *Consider how to use existing information, data or evidence, or identify new sources that can be reasonably obtained with the resources and time available.* *Ensure that information, data or evidence collected reflects the student experience.* *Consider a wide range of information and data sources from different members of the learning community.* *Determine interim milestones and how to use data or evidence to show whether they have been achieved. Adapt activities accordingly.*	The impact on students will be measured through both existing data sources and new tools that capture the student learning experience. Evidence will include performance on summative assessments, with attention to the quality of inquiry and problem-solving shown in GRASPS-based tasks. Teacher records of ATL skill development will be monitored across subjects to track student growth, while student reflections, surveys, and focus groups will provide feedback on interdisciplinary connections and the relevance of their learning. Interim milestones will include more consistent use of the IB planner across subjects, documented integration of ATL skills in unit plans, and student participation in at least one interdisciplinary task per semester. Progress will be reviewed during bi-weekly workshops and planning meetings, allowing the IB Coordinator and teachers to adjust activities as needed. By combining assessment data, ATL tracking, and student voice, we will ensure that evidence of impact is both measurable and reflective of the student experience.
Additional considerations to strength the plan *Schools are encouraged to plan for these areas, but they are not required.*		
Professional learning	**What professional learning is needed to support the program development goal?** *Consider what knowledge, skills or capabilities are needed for the plan to have the identified impact.* *Consider identifying strengths and capabilities that staff and leadership already have and setting up structures to provide school-based professional learning opportunities.*	To support this program development goal, teachers and leadership will need targeted professional learning focused on strengthening their ability to plan, deliver, and reflect on high-quality MYP units. While many staff members already bring strong instructional skills and subject expertise, changes in staffing has resulted in gaps in understanding the IB philosophy, unit planning process, and interdisciplinary collaboration. Professional learning will therefore build on existing teacher strengths while ensuring that all staff develop a common foundation in MYP planning practices. School-based opportunities will include bi-weekly workshops led by the IB Coordinator, focused on consistent use of the IB planner, effective integration of ATL skills, and designing inquiry-driven summative assessments using the GRASPS model. Common planning time will also serve as a structured setting for peer feedback and horizontal collaboration. To further strengthen interdisciplinary work, staff will engage in facilitated planning sessions where teachers intentionally design cross-curricular experiences and identify how ATL skills can transfer between subject areas. For teachers and leaders newer to the program, onboarding sessions and

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	Consider any gaps and identify IB or other professional learning that can support the school in achieving the desired impact.	ongoing mentoring will ensure a deeper understanding of international-mindedness, the learner profile, and IB assessment practices. When needed, external IB professional learning workshops will be used to supplement school-based training, particularly in areas such as interdisciplinary unit planning, assessment strategies, and leadership in an IB context. These combined efforts will ensure that all staff, regardless of prior IB experience, have the knowledge, skills, and support needed to sustain the identified impact on student learning.
Academic research studies and shared practice	**What examples shared from other schools might inform the school's approach or activities?** **How might research inform the school's approach or activities?** *Consider identifying published or unpublished research studies or examples from other schools to inform the school's process.* *Consider connecting with other schools in conferences or through remote opportunities.* *Consider the examples in the Learning stories.*	Our approach to strengthening unit planning and interdisciplinary collaboration is informed by examples from other IB World Schools that have successfully built staff capacity during times of transition. Many schools have introduced structured peer-review protocols for unit plans, created interdisciplinary planning teams, and adopted common rubrics for ATL skill development to promote consistency across subject areas. These practices show that sustained professional dialogue and shared tools can help maintain program quality even during periods of high staff turnover. Educational research also supports this direction. Studies on collaborative professional learning highlight that teachers are more effective when given protected time to plan together, receive timely feedback, and reflect on student outcomes. Research on inquiry-based learning emphasizes the value of authentic assessments, such as GRASPS tasks, in increasing student engagement and critical thinking. In addition, literature on interdisciplinary teaching demonstrates that students develop deeper understanding when they can connect ideas across disciplines and apply skills in varied contexts. Together, these insights reinforce the importance of collaborative planning, structured professional learning, and the intentional integration of ATL skills into unit design.
Theory of change	**How will the activities lead to the change the school wants to create for students?** *Some schools may be ready to consider creating a logic model or theory of change to show how the activities will lead to the impact sought. This is a fairly advanced exercise, and this suggestion is for schools looking to advance their program development planning capabilities.*	The planned activities are designed to build a clear chain of improvement that begins with teacher development and leads to a richer learning experience for students. Through common planning time, bi-weekly workshops, and structured peer-review protocols, teachers will gain confidence and consistency in using the IB planner to design concept-driven units that intentionally embed ATL skills, global contexts, and inquiry-based assessments such as GRASPS tasks. This consistency will give students learning experiences that are both engaging and coherent across subjects. Cross-curricular planning will further strengthen alignment of skills and concepts between disciplines, creating authentic interdisciplinary tasks that help students transfer knowledge and skills across contexts. These experiences will deepen student understanding and strengthen their ability to think critically and problem-solve. Over time, the cumulative effect of these activities will be a student body better equipped to inquire, make connections, and apply learning to the world around them. In this way, professional learning and collaborative structures for teachers directly drive the desired changes in student engagement, achievement, and growth.

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Implementation

Complete this implementation section as you plan the activities and during the process if you adapt and modify the planned activities

Implementation		
	Guiding questions and prompts	**School response**
Activities	**What activities will lead to the outcome? (Who will do what? By when?)** *The school will need to develop a clear and detailed plan with identified milestones to achieve the goal that reflects the resources and capacity of the school. The school may have multiple workstreams with many participants engaged in a number of activities. Record only the major activities here.* *Check that the activities in the plan are connected to the selected practices.* *Include all the relevant members of the school community in planning and implementing the activities.* *Set up structures that encourage learning and adaptation.* *Adapt the plan and the activities as needed, based on interim data or feedback from stakeholders.*	Major activities focused on building teacher capacity and strengthening consistent MYP unit planning. Bi-weekly professional development was provided to discipline groups by the IB Coordinator, with the goal of completing two unit planners during the year, one per semester. Teachers successfully completed both planners, which were reviewed by the IB Coordinator with written and individualized feedback provided. New teachers participated in these sessions and were paired with experienced IB teacher leaders within their departments. Teachers requiring formal IB training were also provided with appropriate training, while additional development was provided to teacher leaders to build capacity across the school. Teachers engaged in horizontal and vertical planning within the professional development sessions, strengthening alignment and consistency. An unforeseen interruption in IB Coordinator support for approximately half of the year limited the full implementation of the original plan. Despite this interruption, teachers successfully completed their unit planners and continued developing their understanding of IB practices. Interdisciplinary planning was not fully implemented and has been identified as an area for continued growth in the next PDP cycle.

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Reflection

Complete this reflection section periodically and at the conclusion of the program development activities

Reflection		
	Guiding questions and prompts	**School response**
IB practices	**Indicate if there were any changes to the practices selected and explain why different practices were selected.**	There were no significant changes to the practices selected for this program development plan. The focus remained on strengthening the MYP unit planning process, building teacher capacity through professional learning, and creating structures for teacher collaboration. However, implementation was adjusted due to an unforeseen interruption in IB Coordinator support for approximately half of the school year. As a result, greater emphasis was placed on building the capacity of IB teacher leaders and supporting horizontal and vertical collaboration within departments. Interdisciplinary collaboration was not fully implemented and has been identified as an area for continued development in the next PDP cycle.
Analysis of data and evidence of impact	**Did the work positively impact the student learning experience? How do you know?** **What did the data or evidence show was the impact on students?** *Analyse the data to determine what the impact was on the student experience.* *Establish a structure or protocol with shared expectations to encourage candid sharing.* *Ensure that time is set aside to engage in meaningful analysis and reflection.* *Ensure that all relevant stakeholders participate in the reflection process.*	The student impact analysis was not fully completed due to the interruption in IB Coordinator support for approximately half of the school year. However, teacher feedback and student work samples provided evidence that students were engaging with ATL skills and participating in the inquiry process within their classes. These samples demonstrated progress toward creating more intentional IB learning experiences across subject areas. Reflection with teachers also identified an important area for continued growth. Teachers expressed a need for additional support with conceptual teaching and learning, particularly the use of key and related concepts and the development and implementation of strong Statements of Inquiry. This feedback will help guide future professional development and provides a clear next step for strengthening the student learning experience.
Activities	**What were the major activities undertaken to achieve the outcome?** *Reflect on the planned activities. Did the activities occur as planned? Were they modified or were different activities substituted for what was planned? Why were the changes, if any, needed?*	The major activities included bi-weekly discipline-based professional development, development and review of two MYP unit planners per teacher, individualized feedback, formal IB training, and ongoing support for teachers new to the program. Teachers also engaged in horizontal and vertical planning within their departments. Most activities occurred as planned; however, interdisciplinary planning was not fully implemented due in part to

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	Who participated in the activities? Were there some people or roles that were especially critical to success? Were there people or roles that were missing?	an unforeseen interruption in IB Coordinator support for approximately half of the school year. All instructional staff participated in the professional learning and unit planning process. IB teacher leaders were especially critical to the success of the work, as they provided department-level support and helped maintain momentum during the interruption in coordinator support. While collaboration within departments was successful, greater structured collaboration between disciplines was missing. This will be an important area to address in the next program development cycle.
Examples of impact	**Identify 1–3 examples that evidence the impact on students (for example, documents, photographs, short audio or video files).** *Share these examples with the school community during the reflection to celebrate success and to learn for future program development initiatives.* *If the school selects this plan to share with the IB during program evaluation, these examples can be shared in meetings discussing the impact of program development.*	Student work samples from completed MYP units demonstrating student engagement with ATL skills, inquiry-based learning, and application of learning through unit assessments. Completed MYP unit planners with corresponding student work samples showing how teacher planning translated into inquiry-driven learning experiences and student products. Teacher feedback and reflections documenting observations of student engagement with the inquiry process and ATL skills, as well as areas identified for continued growth in conceptual teaching and learning.
Additional considerations for reflection *Schools are encouraged to reflect on this area, but it is not required.*		
Academic research studies and shared practice	**Were there additional examples or research that informed the approach or activities?** *Did the school connect with other schools or find examples that informed the work? Describe what the school used.*	

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Understanding and application

Complete this understanding and application section at the conclusion of the program development activities

Understanding and application		
	Guiding questions and prompts	**School response**
Summary	**What did the school learn from engaging in this program development effort?** **What factors led to this effort having, or not having, an impact?** *What can be learned from the changes that were made to the plan?* *What can make the process easier or more effective next time?* *What made it work or not work well?* *Ensure that all relevant stakeholders participate in the reflection process to consider the impact on students.*	Our school learned that sustained program development requires shared ownership, clear expectations, and ongoing support. The bi-weekly professional development, manageable goal of completing two unit planners, individualized feedback, and use of IB teacher leaders were important factors in the success of the effort. Building teacher-leader capacity was especially valuable because it allowed the work to continue despite the interruption in IB Coordinator support. At the same time, the interruption limited our ability to fully implement interdisciplinary planning and conduct a comprehensive analysis of student impact. Moving forward, the process can be strengthened by distributing leadership responsibilities earlier, establishing systems for collecting student evidence throughout the year, and creating dedicated opportunities for interdisciplinary collaboration. Teacher feedback also demonstrated a need for deeper professional learning around conceptual teaching and learning, which should inform the next program development effort.
Further or future considerations	**What was learned about the school's program development process from this reflection?** *How can the lessons be noted and intentionally applied to future program development plans?* *Here, record the transferable learning about the process.*	This process reinforced the importance of building shared leadership and teacher capacity so that program development does not depend on one individual. Developing IB teacher leaders and providing consistent collaborative structures helped sustain the work even when IB Coordinator support was interrupted. The experience also demonstrated that focused, manageable goals, such as completing one unit planner per semester, allowed teachers to build their understanding of IB practices over time. Future program development plans should continue to incorporate distributed leadership, clear milestones, regular professional learning, and opportunities for teacher feedback and reflection. Plans should also include structures for continuity when staffing or leadership changes occur and more intentional methods for

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		collecting evidence of student impact throughout the implementation process.
Next priorities (areas of focus for future program development plans)	**What areas of the program will the school now prioritize for development? Why?** *What could be the focus of the school's next program development plan?* *Does the focus chosen for this program development plan need further development?* *Is the school ready to choose a new focus for the next program development plan?*	The school will prioritize strengthening conceptual teaching and learning and the intentional development of ATL skills across the MYP. While teachers demonstrated growth in completing MYP unit planners, feedback identified a need for deeper understanding of key and related concepts, Statements of Inquiry, and how these elements connect to classroom instruction. Student work also showed emerging use of ATL skills, creating an opportunity to strengthen how these skills are intentionally taught, practiced, and reinforced across disciplines. The next program development plan should build on the foundation of unit planning by focusing on how conceptual learning and ATL skills move from the planner into daily instruction and the student learning experience. This focus will also create opportunities for greater horizontal, vertical, and interdisciplinary alignment so that students experience consistent development of ATL skills across the program.

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